

Staple food prices remain high following the recent blockade

Key Messages

- Large populations in Yemen continue to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) acute food insecurity. As worst-affected households begin to exhaust their coping capacity, populations may begin to move into Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) even in the absence of additional disruptions. In a worst-case scenario, significant declines in commercial imports below requirement levels and conflict that cuts populations off from trade and humanitarian assistance for an extended period could drive food security outcomes in line with Famine (IPC Phase 5).
- The major ports in Yemen remain open and imports continue to flow through Al Hudaydah, Salif, and Aden. However, levels of imports for food and fuel, specifically through the Red Sea ports at Al Hudaydah and Salif, remain volatile and in February were lower than pre-blockade levels. However, WFP reports suggest national-level stocks of cereals and rice have increased by approximately 25 percent between late January and late March, from approximately 684,000 MT to 851,000 MT.
- Prices of staple foods and fuel were generally stable between January and February, but remain higher than immediately prior to the blockade and higher than pre-crisis levels. For example, retail prices of wheat flour in Al Hudaydah, Aden, and Sana'a City are approximately 25 to 35 percent higher than in October 2017 prior to the blockade, and 45 to 65 percent higher than in January 2015 prior to the current conflict. Larger price increases have been observed for fuel. February 2018 retail diesel prices are 25 to 70 percent higher than October 2017 levels and 100 to 125 percent higher than January 2015 levels on the same three markets.
- Significant levels of new displacement continue to occur in Yemen, particularly along the western coast. Since December 2017, approximately 15,982 households have been displaced by conflict in or near Al Hudaydah, Ta'izz, Ibb, and Lahij governorates. Most newly displaced households (40 percent and 20 percent, respectively) are located within Al Hudaydah and Ta'izz, and according to partners, require multi-sectoral assistance.

* FEWS NET classification is **IPC**-compatible with limited exceptions. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. In rare cases, FEWS NET classification is IPC-aligned but not IPC-compatible. IPC-aligned analysis is evidence-based but some types of evidence required for IPC-compatibility were not available.

Key Message Update

This Key Message Update provides a high-level analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography. Learn more [here](#).